# ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 01

**Reading · Writing & Grammar · Literature (First Flight, Poetry, Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 80

## SECTION — A — Answers — 20 Marks

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(i) (a)** carries a library, cinema and post office in its pocket | 1 |
| | **(ii) (c)** giving one's full time to one writer's book | 1 |
| | **(iii) (d)** grows strong when it holds a weight for some time | 1 |
| | **(iv) (a)** A girl learning to repair a pump from a video | 1 |
| | **(v) (c)** a very patient salesman | 1 |
| | **(vi)** Information. | 1 |
| | **(vii)** Earlier people read long books attentively; today people only skim headlines and first lines. | 1 |
| | **(viii)** To read something printed for thirty minutes daily with the phone kept in another room. | 1 |
| | **(ix)** Remedy. | 1 |
| | **(x)** Weak. | 1 |
| 2 | **(i) (a)** Screen entertainment | 1 |
| | **(ii) (c)** 20 | 1 |
| | **(iii) (b)** 20 minutes | 1 |
| | **(iv)** 75 + 20 = 95 minutes. | 1 |
| | **(v)** 200. | 1 |
| | **(vi)** 110 − 55 = 55 minutes. | 1 |
| | **(vii)** They read very little compared with other activities. | 1 |
| | **(viii)** Hold a daily silent-reading period or a book-swap week. | 1 |
| | **(ix)** Survey. | 1 |
| | **(x)** Not specified; students of Classes 9 and 10 generally. | 1 |

## SECTION — B — Answers — 12 Marks

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 3 | **NOTICE**<br>Mastermind Public School, Jaipur<br>10 November 2026<br>**CAREER COUNSELLING SESSION**<br>A career counselling session for Classes 10 and 12 will be held on 24 November 2026 at 11 a.m. in the seminar hall. A career expert will speak on courses and opportunities. Students should bring questions.<br>School Counsellor | 3 |
| | **OR: NOTICE**<br>Mastermind Public School, Jaipur<br>10 November 2026<br>**CANTEEN CLOSED**<br>The school canteen will remain closed from 16 to 20 November 2026 for repairs. Students are requested to bring their own tiffin and water. Regular services will resume on 21 November.<br>Vice Principal | 3 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **4** | 3, Station Road<br>Kota<br>10 November 2026<br>The Editor<br>The Rajasthan Times<br>Kota<br>Subject: Noise pollution<br>Sir,<br>Through your newspaper I wish to draw the attention of the authorities to the rising noise pollution in our city. Loud horns, DJ systems and loudspeakers disturb students, patients and the elderly. Public examinations make it worse. I request the authorities to enforce the laws on noise limits, to ban pressure horns and to fix silent zones near schools and hospitals. Citizens too should cooperate. I hope action will be taken soon.<br>Yours faithfully,<br>Vimal/Vimla | 5 |
| | **OR:** 9, Ashok Vihar<br>Jaipur<br>10 November 2026<br>Dear Mohit,<br>Thank you very much for the beautiful wristwatch you sent me on my birthday. It was a wonderful surprise, and I loved the design. I have been wearing it every day, and my friends admire it. It will also help me to be punctual! My birthday was a happy one, and your gift made it even better. I hope you will visit us in the winter holidays. Give my regards to uncle and aunt.<br>Yours affectionately,<br>Gaurav/Gauri | 5 |
| **5** | Punctuality means doing things at the right time. A punctual person is respected and trusted. Time lost is never regained, and a student who finishes tasks on time has leisure for sports and hobbies. Punctuality also reduces stress, as one need not hurry at the last minute. In business and public life, being late can cause loss and annoyance to others. Great persons such as Mahatma Gandhi were extremely punctual. We should therefore make a habit of keeping time from childhood.<br>*(Content 2 · Organisation 1 · Language 1)* | 4 |
| | **OR:** A balanced diet contains the right amounts of carbohydrates, proteins, fats, vitamins and minerals. It gives energy, builds the body and fights disease. Fruits, vegetables, pulses, milk and cereals should form a part of the daily meal. Junk food, which has too much oil and sugar, causes obesity and tiredness. Drinking enough water is equally important. Students, who need energy to study and play, should avoid skipping breakfast. A healthy diet today is the foundation of a healthy life tomorrow.<br>*(Content 2 · Organisation 1 · Language 1)* | 4 |

## SECTION — C — Answers

**8 Marks**

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| **6** | did not come. | 1 |
| **7** | should. | 1 |
| **8** | a. | 1 |
| **9** | She said that she had finished her work. | 1 |
| **10** | My bag has been stolen (by someone). | 1 |
| **11** | The man who is standing at the gate is my uncle. | 1 |
| **12** | He is one of the best players in the team. | 1 |
| **13** | Mr Mehta taught us English last year. | 1 |

## SECTION — D — Answers

**8 Marks**

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| **14** | **(c)** Thabo Mbeki — *De Klerk was second deputy president* | 1 |
| **15** | **(d)** scolding and threatening to let him starve — *Upbraiding and threatening* | 1 |
| **16** | **(c)** paper listens without judging or getting tired — *A diary can hold her thoughts patiently* | 1 |
| **17** | **(a)** desire (and passion/greed) — *From what the poet has 'tasted of desire'* | 1 |
| **18** | **(c)** bright, bold colouring — *His beauty* | 1 |
| **19** | **(c)** Hari Singh — *He took a new name every month* | 1 |
| **20** | **(a)** young writer — *Romantic and eager for adventure* | 1 |
| **21** | **(d)** rare, expensive books — *He bought them secretly* | 1 |

## SECTION — E — Answers — 12 Marks

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 22 | **(i)** Teachers were to decide who would move up and who would be kept back. | 1 |
| | **(ii)** Making bets on who would pass. | 1 |
| | **(iii)** Maths. | 1 |
| | **(iv)** She talked too much in class. | 1 |
| 23 | **(i)** It bounced down the street and fell into the water. | 1 |
| | **(ii)** That there are other balls. | 1 |
| | **(iii)** He is gripped by grief and stands stiff, trembling. | 1 |
| | **(iv)** Rigid. | 1 |
| 24 | **(i)** On the sixth and top floor of a French hotel. | 1 |
| | **(ii)** Ausable did not fit his picture of a secret agent. | 1 |
| | **(iii)** Mysterious figures, pistols and adventure. | 1 |
| | **(iv)** Musty. | 1 |

## SECTION — F — Answers — 8 Marks

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 25 | His friend sent two Arabs with a squirming sack containing an otter from the Tigris marshes along with a note: 'Here is your otter'. | 2 |
| 26 | She carried her dead child from house to house asking for medicine. | 2 |
| 27 | Perhaps she is embarrassed or silent about important changes; people often hide unexpected happenings. | 2 |
| 28 | After setting fire to his landlord's house he had to remove his clothes to escape unseen, leaving him naked and penniless. | 2 |

## SECTION — G — Answers — 12 Marks

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 29 | Even in prison, he saw a glimmer of humanity in a guard for a second, which reassured him and kept him going; goodness remains in people despite oppression. | 3 |
| | **OR:** Curious, determined, independent, thrifty, proud, imaginative, shy; she saved money, refused help, said she was not a child, declined a drink and appreciated the world. | 3 |
| 30 | Yes; Horace trusted the woman and was cheated; the story questions whether a thief can be trusted; it also questions trusting appearances. | 3 |
| | **OR:** Bishamber arrives with a procession; lifts the veil, sees pock-marks and asks for five thousand; Ramlal pays; Bholi throws the garland into the fire and refuses. | 3 |
| 31 | Nervous, hypochondriac, excitable, suspicious, argumentative, but practical about marriage; wealthy landowner. | 3 |
| | **OR:** He is an obedient but observant apprentice; his 'bits of data' correct Think-Tank, but he flatters him and executes orders. | 3 |
| 32 | Fire and ice are natural opposites used to represent intense passion and cold hate; they show that extremes of feeling lead to ruin. | 3 |
| | **OR:** Contrast between the loud orders and quiet fantasies, bracketed and unbracketed stanzas, nagging and freedom. | 3 |

**Evaluator's note:** Answers given are model answers / value points; accept any other relevant and correct response in the candidate's own words. For writing tasks, marks are for format, content, organisation and accuracy of language. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted.